

sage conversation.” You can customise this message just for fun, or if you have a company, you can make the message reflect company policy. You can also make a blank message appear, of course.

Navigate to:

HLM\SOFTWARE\Microsoft\MessengerService\Policies

Create or modify a String Value called IMWarning. Set it to whatever text you want to show up as the warning.

Restart or log out of Windows and back in for the change to take effect.

A New-Look Messenger

You always see those two rounded characters in the MSN Messenger window—change that picture to whatever you want!

First, locate the installation directory for MSN Messenger, which could be, for example, C:\Program Files\Messenger. This location can be found in the Registry.

Navigate to:

HLM\SOFTWARE\Microsoft\MessengerService

Look at the InstallationDirectory value. That’s where your file is. Then go to that folder, and rename the “lvback.gif” file there to “lvback.old”, just for a backup. Then copy your desired image (this should be a GIF) to the folder and name it “lvback.gif.”

Just restart MSN Messenger for the change to take effect.

Remove Windows Messenger From IE

This tweak can be used to remove the integration of Windows Messenger into Internet Explorer: it will remove both the toolbar icon and Tools menu item.